

74.7 FRACTIONS

You might see fractions written out as words. Aside from “half” ($\frac{1}{2}$) and “quarter” ($\frac{1}{4}$), the bottom number of a fraction is written or spoken as an ordinal number.

$\frac{1}{4}$

a quarter

Use ordinal numbers for the bottom of a fraction.

$\frac{1}{3}$

a third

$\frac{1}{2}$

a half

Use cardinal numbers for the top of a fraction.

$\frac{3}{5}$

three fifths

$1\frac{1}{2}$

one and a half

Use “and” to link a whole number and a fraction.

74.8 DECIMALS

Decimals are always written as numbers, not words. The decimal point is spoken as “point,” and all numbers after the decimal point are spoken separately.

There are three ways of saying decimals that begin with 0.

point five

0.5

nought point five

UK only.

zero point five

1.7

one point seven

3.97

three point nine seven

This is not said as “three point ninety-seven.”

Decimal points are written in English using a period, or full stop.

74.9 PERCENTAGES

The % symbol is written and spoken as “percent.” “Per cent” is also sometimes written in UK English. Percentages are normally written as numbers, not words.

1%

one percent

99%

ninety-nine percent

55.5%

fifty-five point five percent

12%

twelve per cent

70%

seventy per cent

100%

one hundred per cent